

How to use Google Drive, OneDrive, Dropbox, Amazon S3 and more in Linux

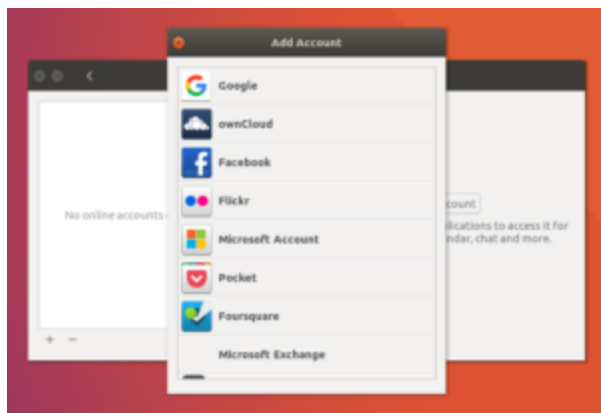
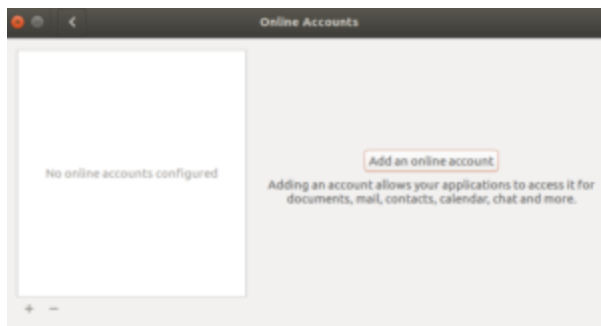
Google Drive hasn't been supported on Linux officially, well, ever....

It's been possible to use it in the past using third party apps like [inSync](#) or the more basic [Gdrive](#). However since version 3.18, the GNOME desktop has inbuilt support for Google Drive 'files'.

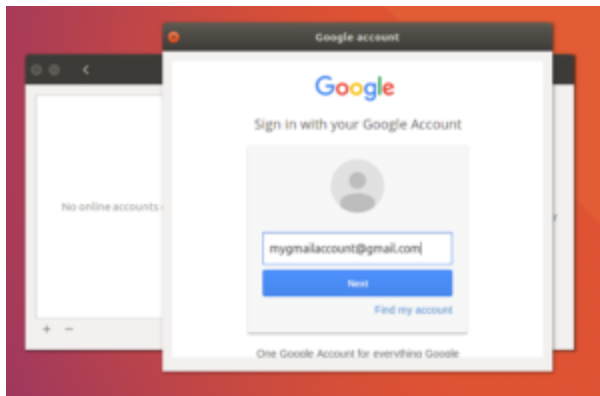
We will also be covering a third party tool called RCloneBrowser which supports OneDrive and Dropbox as well as Google Drive, so you can choose whether you'd like to use the new 'native' inbuilt support for Google Drive, or use a third party tool. The choice is yours, vive la Linux freedom!

Setting up your Google Account

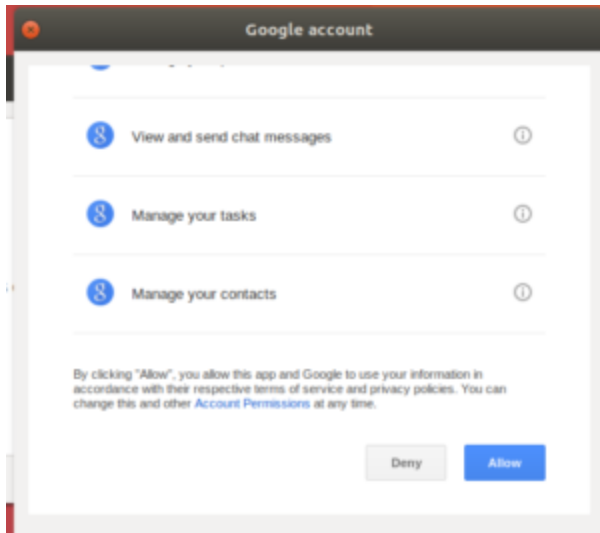
Now onto the fun stuff! Click on the Online Accounts icon in your control panel. Unless you have set up online accounts before, this should be a relatively spartan box. Click 'Add an online account'. You'll see another dialogue box come up with a whole bunch of cloud services. Google is at the top, click on that.



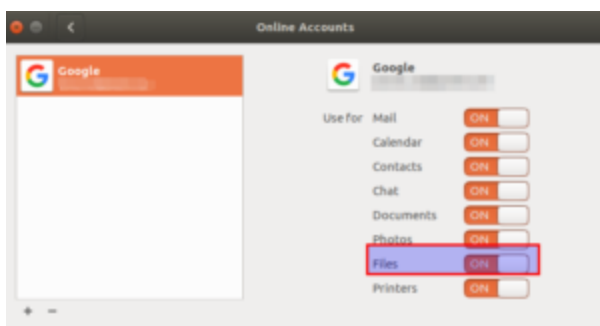
You'll next be asked to enter your google credentials, go ahead and fill them in.



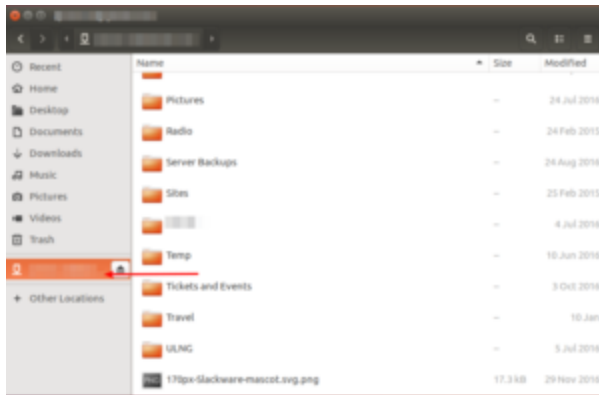
Once you have entered your Gmail address/username and password, you will be prompted to give Ubuntu / GNOME permission to use your Google account. Scroll to the bottom of that dialogue and press 'Allow'.



A few moments later, you will see the original 'Online Accounts' box, however you'll see it now has your Google account in there. You can see that one of the options is 'Files'. By default this option is selected as 'On'.



Finally, if you open the File Manager (Nautilus), you'll see a new entry (most likely below 'Trash'). It should have your Google account username. Click on that and you'll start to see your files (this may take quite some considerable time!).



What else do I need to know?

I have a lot of stuff in my Google Drive account. My photos alone are around 50GB. Browsing through the folders can take quite a while. This is a problem when you find out that none of the content is locally stored offline. Fortunately, every change you make is synchronised, including file deletion, copy and add. So, be aware that performance might not be ideal when you browse some of your larger folders.

RcloneBrowser: OneDrive, Dropbox, S3 and more

RCloneBrowser is a QT5 based GUI that you can synchronise files from Google Drive, Google Cloud Storage, Dropbox, Microsoft OneDrive, Amazon S3, Amazon Drive, Openstack Swift / Rackspace Cloud, Memset memstore, Hubic, Yandex Disk and Backblaze B2. An impressive list!

If you know what RSync is (which is great!), you'll love RClone. It's basically rsync for cloud storage. RCloneBrowser is the GUI for RClone!

The only unfortunate thing about RCloneBrowser is that it's new, and not prime-time yet. It's not included by default in the Ubuntu Repositories, nor in most of the other popular distributions. So, you'll either need to download (and compile) the source code, or download a binary. For more information on what compiling/binaries are all about, [check out this guide](#).

Either way, RCloneBrowser is not as easy to get going for a newbie as one would hope. I'm sure it will be soon, but hopefully when you get it going, it will be worth the reward.

To install RCloneBrowser, you'll need two packages, and you'll need to install RCloneBrowser from source:

1. Firstly, you'll need the Rclone binary (the text mode version of the RcloneBrowser tool). [Download it at rclone.org](#) (or for the latest developer releases, [Get it from GitHub](#)). Install the binary as specified in the documentation.
2. Next, download [RcloneBrowser from the github site](#).
3. Go to the Terminal and Install build-essential and cmake as well as the Qt5 dev tools: `sudo apt-get install build-essential cmake qt5-default pyqt5-dev` (you may need other QT5 build tools depending upon your distro).
4. Unzip the RCloneBrowser package you downloaded and inside the folder it creates, create a folder called 'build' next to the src folder
5. Run `cmake .` from the build folder. If cmake doesn't find Qt, add `-DCMAKE_PREFIX_PATH=path/to/Qt` to previous command
6. Run `cmake --build .` from build folder to create binary
7. Optionally run `sudo make install` to install it to all users on the system, or to put it into the system path.

Other Alternatives

- [overDrive](#) is a \$5 paid application with a 14 day trial. It works very much like the Google Drive client for Windows/Mac.
- [inSync](#) (which I have used with great success), is a graphical (and console based) \$30 Google Drive client. It also a two week trial.
- Dropbox has native support within the GNOME Online Accounts dialogue.
- ownCloud / nextCloud is a great open source alternative to other cloud storage systems. It can be run from home or a server online.

For those of you interested in console only based offerings, you can check out:

- [GDrive2](#) by Paul Rasmussen supports basic syncing. It only syncs one way at the time and works more like rsync than e.g. dropbox.
- [Drive](#) is an unofficial tool written by a Google developer. It doesn't sync, you must manually tell it to push or pull updates.